

Finite-Rank Obstructions for Locally Constant Multiplier Clocks: An Audited PCF Markov–Baker Note

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Abstract

We prove an exact obstruction for multiplier clocks on finite symbolic models. For one fixed finite-state system with a finite-memory, locally constant, nonzero scalar multiplicative cocycle, every periodic instability length lies in a finite-dimensional rational vector space. Since logarithms of distinct rational primes are rationally linearly independent, such a clock cannot realize all prime logarithms term by term. We certify the obstruction on a three-state post-critically finite Markov factor and its compact labeled Markov–baker realization. The carrier is almost everywhere invertible and exact symplectic on every affine branch interior. Two independent primitive-cycle enumerations, an all-period boundary-quotient proof, and an independent 100-digit parent audit verify the construction. There are 226 primitive symbolic cycles through period 20, but every period- $2k$ orbit has unstable multiplier modulus 2^k and length $k \log 2$; hence the rational-prime intersection is only $\log 2$, and the multiplier product is $(1 - 2^{1-s})^{-1}$. The carrier therefore passes its structural checks while the arithmetic gate fails; the intrinsic orbit ledger is formally weak because it has no arithmetic labels. The theorem concerns exact termwise containment for locally constant scalar clocks, not variable roofs, countable-state models, matrix spectral radii, or approximate prime resemblance.

1 Introduction

A finite symbolic model may carry every orbit exactly and still carry too little metric information to support an arithmetic correspondence. This distinction matters whenever primitive periodic orbits are compared with the rational primes. A symbolic language supplies primitive objects and their repetitions; an arithmetic model also needs an intrinsic clock whose primitive lengths can support the proposed labels. Neither a rational dynamical zeta nor reciprocal symplectic multipliers establish that second property by themselves.

Arithmetic–spectral analogies motivate exact tests of this separation [Berry and Keating, 1999]. Here the requested clock is the instability length $L(C) = \log |\Lambda_u(C)|$ of a periodic orbit. The question is deliberately termwise: can one fixed dynamical model contain $\log p$ for every rational prime p , without inserting a prime table into local weights? This paper does not compare a fitted spectrum with Riemann zeros. Instead, it identifies an assumption class for which the termwise question is settled before any target data are opened.

The frozen band-merging parameter and its prime-symbolic motivation are inherited from the author’s earlier non-autonomous Logistic-map study [Wang, 2026]. The present paper neither

revalidates that study’s prime-sieve claims nor imports its prime data. It asks the different, autonomous question of whether an exact branch-history carrier supplies an adequate periodic multiplier clock, and it permits a negative answer.

Our main observation is elementary but restrictive. Higher-block presentations, locally constant weights, and periodic-orbit sums are standard symbolic-dynamics tools [Lind and Marcus, 2021, Parry and Pollicott, 1990, Marcus and Tuncel, 1991]; we make no priority claim for finite-span containment by itself. The point of the note is its arithmetic design consequence. A finite graph with a finite-memory locally constant scalar cocycle has only finitely many local log-multipliers. All closed-walk lengths therefore lie in their finite $\mathbb{Q}$ -span, whereas distinct prime logarithms are $\mathbb{Q}$ -linearly independent. We give the complete argument, sharpen the bound to the span generated by closed walks, and record a sharp finite-rank example. The result does not extend to a point-dependent derivative merely because its symbolic coding is finite.

The worked case is a post-critically finite (PCF) quadratic map with a three-state Markov factor. Perron–Frobenius geometry realizes its two-sided branch history as a compact disjoint union of three labeled rectangles. Each allowed branch expands and contracts by reciprocal factors $\sqrt{2}$ and $1/\sqrt{2}$, with simultaneous coordinate reversal on a decreasing parent branch. The resulting baker is exact symplectic on branch interiors and almost everywhere invertible. Generalized baker and natural-extension constructions are classical [Bose, 1989, Bruin and Kalle, 2014]; the construction is used here as an auditable certificate, not presented as a new formalism.

The exact orbit calculation exposes the obstruction in its simplest form. Every closed word has even period $2k$, so

$$|\Lambda_u(C)| = 2^k, \quad L(C) = k \log 2, \quad Z_u(s) = \frac{1}{1 - 2^{1-s}}.$$

Direct canonical-word enumeration and trace/Möbius inversion agree on 226 primitive symbolic cycles through period 20. A single symbolic period-two boundary orbit is replaced by a parent fixed point. The corresponding parent zeta is treated as a reproduction baseline rather than a novelty claim; the broader RLR^∞ kneading setting is discussed in [Alesdà et al., 2025].

The contributions are therefore narrow and falsifiable:

1. We prove the finite-rank obstruction for one fixed finite-state, finite-memory, locally constant scalar multiplier clock, including the sharper closed-walk rank bound and its finite-rank sharpness.
2. We give a convention-safe PCF Markov–baker certificate that separates the unsigned orbit zeta, parent boundary quotient, inherited factor orientation, Lefschetz convention, and multiplier product.
3. We verify the rank-one corollary with exact algebra, two orbit ledgers, an independently implemented high-precision parent audit, three locked implementation splits, and six matched controls.

The formal outcome is `A0_FAIL / STRUCTURAL_ONLY` and `A1_WEAK`: the carrier is a structural positive control, but its orbit ledger has no all-prime arithmetic labeling. Downstream determinant fitting and quantization remain outside the declared scope. Figure 1 summarizes the verified carrier geometry and the rank-one clock obstruction without identifying the factor-orientation signs with symplectic orientation.

Section 2 fixes the prior-art boundary. The general obstruction is proved in Section 3. Sections 4 and 5 construct and solve the PCF case. Section 6 reports the certification protocol, and Section 7 gives the formal stopping decision and limitations.

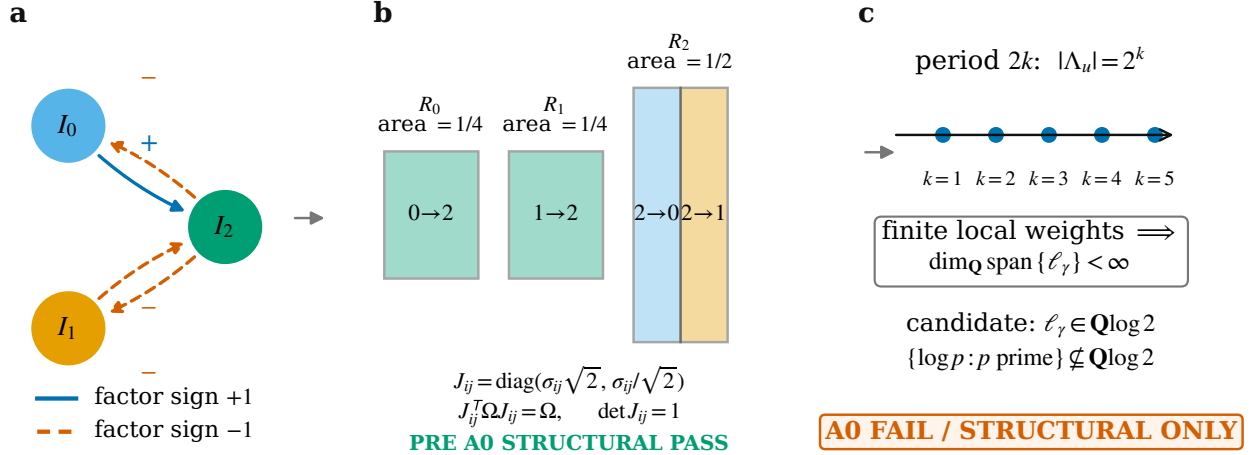


Figure 1: Carrier validity does not imply arithmetic adequacy. (a) The three-state Markov factor has four edges; the solid and dashed styles encode inherited one-dimensional factor signs. (b) Perron–Frobenius areas tile a compact labeled carrier whose branch Jacobians preserve Ω and have determinant one. (c) Every period- $2k$ instability length belongs to $\mathbb{Q} \log 2$, while the full rational-prime logarithm family does not. Thus the carrier passes its structural gate and fails the exact arithmetic clock gate.

2 Prior work and claim boundary

PCF interval maps, kneading, and boundary corrections. Periodic-point zetas originate in the finite-orbit counting framework of [Artin and Mazur \[1965\]](#); finite Markov presentations lead to determinant formulas familiar from symbolic and hyperbolic dynamics [[Bowen and O. E. Lanford, 1970](#)]. Kneading theory organizes analogous information for piecewise monotone interval maps [[Milnor and Thurston, 1988](#)]. Periodic coding at a monotonicity boundary need not be one-to-one: Hofbauer’s Markov-diagram framework already treats the resulting period discrepancies [[Hofbauer, 1985](#)], and weighted kneading theory provides a broader setting for convention-sensitive determinants [[Rugh and Tan, 2015](#)]. The RLR^∞ kneading family is part of the setting studied in *The Real Teapot* [[Alesdà et al., 2025](#)]. We use that paper only as nearby kneading context: the particular determinant identity below is derived directly here and is not attributed to that source. We conservatively treat both the parent formula and the one-orbit boundary correction as reproduction baselines.

Locally constant weights and symbolic recoding. Higher-block presentations and finite-state codes are standard [[Lind and Marcus, 2021](#)]. Locally constant suspension data and weighted periodic-orbit formalisms likewise belong to the established symbolic and hyperbolic-dynamics toolkit [[Parry and Pollicott, 1990](#), [Marcus and Tuncel, 1991](#)]. The finite-span step in Theorem 1 is therefore presented as an elementary lemma with a rational-prime consequence, not as a claim of priority over this literature. The contribution is the explicit design certificate, its sharp scope boundary, and the convention-safe audited example.

Natural extensions and generalized bakers. Passing from a one-sided noninvertible map to a two-sided branch history is a standard way to recover past information. Generalized baker transformations give piecewise-affine geometric realizations [[Bose, 1989](#)], and Hofbauer-tower methods construct natural extensions for broad classes of piecewise-affine maps [[Bruin and Kalle, 2014](#)].

Our finite baker represents a branch code on a labeled disjoint union. We do not claim that this zero-dimensional symbolic system is homeomorphic to the full topological inverse-limit continuum of the quadratic map, or that the factor is a smooth coordinate projection.

Signed weights and quantized bakers. Weighted symbolic determinants can encode branch orientation, but the meaning of a sign depends on the chosen operator and boundary convention. The matrix W used here records the orientation of one-dimensional parent branches; it is neither two-dimensional symplectic orientation nor a Maslov phase. Quantized baker maps also have a substantial independent literature [Balazs and Voros, 1989, Saraceno, 1990]. The existence of a generic baker quantization supplies no arithmetic clock and is not evidence for a canonical quantization of the present candidate.

Arithmetic scope. The motivating comparison is with rational primes, not with the generic “prime orbit” terminology used for primitive dynamical cycles. Our theorem asks only whether all numbers $\log p$ can occur exactly as periodic instability lengths in a fixed clock. It neither asserts a new Hilbert–Pólya construction nor proves that two analytically continued zeta functions must differ. Phase cancellation and analytic continuation require additional hypotheses in a common convergence domain. Thus the PCF determinant, boundary mechanism, baker platform, and finite-state weighted-orbit machinery are prior-art baselines; only the explicit arithmetic certificate and its audited specialization are advanced here.

There is also a directly relevant smooth-dynamical contrast. For every non-exceptional rational map of degree at least two, Ji, Xie, and Zhang prove that the $\mathbb{Q}$ -span of periodic finite characteristic exponents is infinite-dimensional and use the resulting length spectrum to characterize post-critical finiteness [Ji et al., 2026]. Their exponents are normalized by period, whereas (1) below is an unnormalized closed-orbit sum. The present theorem is not a competing general length-spectrum result: it is the elementary finite-locally-constant complement, packaged as a design certificate. In particular, a finite symbolic coding alone never implies a finite-rank derivative clock.

3 Finite-memory clocks and the finite-rank obstruction

Let G be a finite directed graph defining a subshift of finite type. Fix an integer $m \geq 1$, let $\mathcal{B}_m$ be the finite set of allowed length- m blocks, and assign each block a nonzero scalar $\mu_b \in \mathbb{C}^\times$. For a periodic orbit C , blocks are counted with cyclic multiplicity and the modulus-based instability length is

$$L(C) = \sum_{b \in C} \log |\mu_b|. \quad (1)$$

Define

$$V = \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}}\{\log |\mu_b| : b \in \mathcal{B}_m\}, \quad V_{\text{cyc}} = \text{span}_{\mathbb{Q}}\{L(C) : C \text{ periodic}\}. \quad (2)$$

The finite-memory hypothesis includes an edge-local cocycle as $m = 1$ and does not require the multipliers to be algebraic.

Theorem 1 (Finite-rank multiplier-clock obstruction). *Every periodic length in (1) belongs to V , and*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V_{\text{cyc}} \leq \dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V \leq |\mathcal{B}_m| < \infty.$$

Moreover,

$$\#\{p : p \text{ is a rational prime and } L(C) = \log p \text{ for some } C\} \leq \dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V_{\text{cyc}}. \quad (3)$$

Table 1: Scope of Theorem 1. A dash means that the theorem makes no assertion, not that the indicated model can realize an all-prime clock.

Clock class	Finite rank forced?	Theorem applies?	Reason
Fixed finite, locally constant scalar	Yes	Yes	Finite local length set
Finite memory on a finite graph	Yes	Yes	Finite higher-block recoding
Finite prime-weight loop example	Yes	Yes	Sharp at its inserted finite rank
Point-dependent / Hölder roof	–	No	Periodic values need not share a finite span
Countable-state or infinite memory	–	No	Local length set can be infinite
Growing sequence of finite models	Per model	No union claim	Ranks may grow with the model
Matrix spectral radius / singular value	–	No	Generally not a scalar multiplicative cocycle
Approximate or density matching	–	No	Statement is exact and termwise

In particular, one fixed clock satisfying these hypotheses cannot contain $\log p$ for every rational prime.

Proof. First recode the finite-memory rule on the standard higher-block graph [Lind and Marcus, 2021]. Its vertices are allowed words of length $m - 1$, and an allowed length- m block is an edge from its prefix to its suffix. When $m = 1$, retain the original edge presentation. The graph remains finite, and the original block weight becomes an edge-local weight. Periodic sequences and cyclic block multiplicities are unchanged.

For an orbit C , let $N_b(C) \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ count occurrences of b . Then

$$L(C) = \sum_{b \in \mathcal{B}_m} N_b(C) \log |\mu_b| \in V.$$

Thus $V_{\text{cyc}} \subseteq V$, while V is spanned by the finite family of local lengths. This proves the dimension inequalities. Blocks with $|\mu_b| = 1$ contribute zero and do not affect the argument; complex phases do not enter because the clock was defined using modulus.

It remains to bound prime logarithms. Distinct rational-prime logarithms are linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$. Indeed, if $\sum_{i=1}^r q_i \log p_i = 0$, choose a positive common denominator D and set $n_i = Dq_i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Exponentiation gives $\prod_i p_i^{n_i} = 1$. Moving negative exponents to the other side yields an equality of positive integers whose two sides use disjoint prime sets. Unique factorization forces every n_i , hence every q_i , to vanish.

Every prime logarithm realized by a periodic orbit lies in V_{cyc} . Such logarithms form a linearly independent subset of that finite-dimensional space, so their number is at most $\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V_{\text{cyc}}$. This proves (3) and the all-prime obstruction. $\square$

The rank bound is sharp as an abstract finite-graph statement. A one-vertex graph with r self-loops weighted by distinct primes $p_1, \dots, p_r$ realizes the independent lengths $\log p_1, \dots, \log p_r$. This example explicitly inserts a finite prime list; it is not an arithmetic-origin construction.

The locally constant and scalar assumptions are essential. A smooth map with a finite Markov partition can still have a point-dependent derivative and infinitely many rationally independent orbit lengths; the rational-map result of Ji et al. [2026] makes this contrast precise for normalized periodic characteristic exponents of non-exceptional maps. Likewise, spectral radii and largest singular values of matrix products are not generally multiplicative local scalars. Theorem 1 is therefore an elementary design-class certificate, not a no-go theorem for arbitrary smooth symplectic dynamics and not a finite-rank assertion about the nonlinear quadratic parent below.

4 A compact PCF Markov–baker carrier

4.1 The parent and its finite Markov factor

Consider

$$f_u(x) = 1 - ux^2, \quad p(u) = u^3 - 2u^2 + 2u - 2, \quad (4)$$

where u is the unique root of p in $(3859/2500, 15437/10000)$, and set $d = u - 1$. Exact reduction modulo $p(u)$ gives

$$0 \mapsto 1 \mapsto -d \mapsto d \mapsto d. \quad (5)$$

Thus the postcritical core is partitioned into $I_0 = [-d, 0]$, $I_1 = [0, d]$, and $I_2 = [d, 1]$. Their endpoint images, in the displayed orientation, are

$$(f(-d), f(0)) = (d, 1), \quad (f(0), f(d)) = (1, d), \quad (f(d), f(1)) = (d, -d). \quad (6)$$

The unsigned adjacency matrix and the *factor-orientation matrix* are therefore

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad W = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ -1 & -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (7)$$

Equivalently, the allowed signed edges are $0 \rightarrow 2$ with sign $+1$, and $1 \rightarrow 2$, $2 \rightarrow 0$, $2 \rightarrow 1$ with sign -1 . These signs record monotonicity of the one-dimensional factor; they do not record symplectic orientation.

The Perron–Frobenius eigenvalue is $\lambda = \sqrt{2}$. We use the normalized left and right vectors

$$\ell = r = (1/2, 1/2, 1/\sqrt{2})^\top, \quad Ar = \lambda r, \quad \ell^\top A = \lambda \ell^\top, \quad \ell^\top r = 1. \quad (8)$$

The labeled carrier is the compact disjoint union

$$\mathcal{R} = \bigsqcup_{i=0}^2 R_i, \quad R_i = \{i\} \times [0, r_i] \times [0, \ell_i], \quad (9)$$

with rectangle areas $(\ell_i r_i)_i = (1/4, 1/4, 1/2)$. Labels are part of the state, even when two rectangles have equal dimensions.

For each allowed edge $i \rightarrow j$, allocate a vertical source strip of width r_j/λ in R_i and a horizontal destination strip of height ℓ_i/λ in R_j . The two eigenvector identities in (8) say exactly that these strips tile every source and destination rectangle. Ordering equal-source or equal-target edges by label gives offsets

$$s_{ij} = \sum_{j' < j} \frac{A_{ij'} r_{j'}}{\lambda}, \quad t_{ij} = \sum_{i' < i} \frac{\ell_{i'} A_{i'j}}{\lambda}. \quad (10)$$

Write $\sigma_{ij} = W_{ij}$ on an allowed edge. In local rectangle coordinates the branch map is

$$B_{ij}(x, y) = \begin{cases} (\lambda(x - s_{ij}), t_{ij} + y/\lambda), & \sigma_{ij} = +1, \\ (r_j - \lambda(x - s_{ij}), t_{ij} + (\ell_i - y)/\lambda), & \sigma_{ij} = -1. \end{cases} \quad (11)$$

The simultaneous reversal in the second line is essential: reversing only one coordinate would make the branch anti-symplectic.

Proposition 2 (Piecewise exact-symplectic carrier). *On every branch interior, B_{ij} is an exact symplectic affine diffeomorphism from its source strip to its destination strip. The deterministic half-open realization is one-to-one and onto away from the finite union of strip-boundary faces. Retaining all closed strip faces instead defines a forward/inverse relation whose two directions agree.*

Proof. The derivative on an allowed branch is

$$DB_{ij} = \text{diag}(\sigma_{ij}\sqrt{2}, \sigma_{ij}/\sqrt{2}). \quad (12)$$

It has determinant one and therefore, in dimension two, $(DB_{ij})^\top \Omega DB_{ij} = \Omega$ for $\Omega = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$. This proves preservation of $dx \wedge dy$, but exactness requires one more calculation. With the Liouville primitive $\alpha = x dy$, every branch has the affine form $B_{ij}(x, y) = (ax + b, a^{-1}y + c)$, where $a = \sigma_{ij}\sqrt{2}$. Hence

$$B_{ij}^* \alpha - \alpha = (ax + b)a^{-1}dy - x dy = \frac{b}{a} dy = d\left(\frac{b}{a}y\right). \quad (13)$$

Thus the preserved symplectic form and the primitive difference are exact on each branch interior.

The right PF identity tiles every source rectangle by the vertical strips; the left identity tiles every destination rectangle by the horizontal strips. Formula (11) maps each such strip bijectively onto its paired strip, and solving its two affine coordinates gives its inverse. Choose strips left-closed and right-open, except for the last outer endpoint; make the analogous deterministic choice for destination strips. Then each nonboundary point selects exactly one edge in either direction. If all faces are closed instead, a shared face may select two adjacent edges, and the same affine equations show equality of the resulting forward and inverse relations. The exceptional faces have area zero. $\square$

Proposition 2 is deliberately local. The map is piecewise affine on branch interiors, not a global C^1 symplectomorphism. It is a compact labeled realization of two-sided branch history, not a homeomorphism with the full inverse-limit continuum of f_u , and the factor to the interval is not asserted to be a smooth submersion. Appendix A records the root certificate, while Appendix B makes the half-open and closed-boundary conventions explicit.

5 Periodic ledger, boundary quotient, and the candidate clock

5.1 Unsigned cycles and the parent quotient

Let $N_n = \text{tr}(A^n)$ count points fixed by the n th shift iterate, and let P_n count primitive orbits of least period n . The standard trace/Möbius relation [Lind and Marcus, 2021, Bowen and O. E. Lanford, 1970] is

$$N_n = \sum_{q|n} q P_q, \quad P_n = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{q|n} \mu(q) N_{n/q}. \quad (14)$$

Since the eigenvalues of A are $0, \sqrt{2}, -\sqrt{2}$,

$$N_n = \begin{cases} 0, & n \text{ odd}, \\ 2^{k+1}, & n = 2k. \end{cases} \quad (15)$$

Trace/Möbius inversion and a second algorithm that directly enumerates closed words, rejects proper repetitions, and takes the least cyclic rotation agree through period 20. Their common primitive-count vector is

$$(P_1, \dots, P_{20}) = (0, 2, 0, 1, 0, 2, 0, 3, 0, 6, 0, 9, 0, 18, 0, 30, 0, 56, 0, 99), \quad (16)$$

whose entries sum to 226.

Lemma 3 (Sole periodic boundary identification). *For the endpoint-split Markov coding defined by I_0, I_1, I_2 , the coding of parent periodic orbits is one-to-one and period-preserving except at the fixed point d . Its symbolic preimage is the single primitive period-two orbit $1 \leftrightarrow 2$. Consequently no other primitive-period correction occurs at any period.*

Proof. For the standard monotone Markov coding, an admissible periodic word determines its parent periodic point; the exceptional multiplicities and period changes can occur only when an iterate lies on a monotonicity-partition endpoint [Hofbauer, 1985, Lind and Marcus, 2021]. Away from those endpoints, each iterate belongs to a unique interval, so the endpoint-split itinerary is unique. Here

$$E = \{-d, 0, d, 1\}, \quad 0 \mapsto 1 \mapsto -d \mapsto d \mapsto d.$$

If a periodic parent orbit meets E , the endpoint it meets must itself be periodic. The displayed endpoint dynamics shows that d is the only such point. Since $d \in I_1 \cap I_2$, only labels 1 and 2 are available there. Restricting the adjacency matrix (7) to these labels leaves exactly the transitions $1 \rightarrow 2$ and $2 \rightarrow 1$; neither $1 \rightarrow 1$ nor $2 \rightarrow 2$ is allowed. Thus the only symbolic orbit over d is the primitive two-cycle $1 \leftrightarrow 2$. Every other periodic orbit avoids the endpoint ambiguity and keeps its least period. $\square$

Lemma 3 replaces the symbolic period-two boundary ghost by the parent fixed point d . Thus the parent minus symbolic primitive-count delta is $(+1, -1, 0, \dots)$ for all periods, not merely through the audit cutoff. At the Euler-product level the ratio is

$$\frac{1 - z^2}{1 - z} = 1 + z. \quad (17)$$

Directly,

$$\det(I - zA) = 1 - 2z^2, \quad \zeta_A(z) = \frac{1}{1 - 2z^2}, \quad \zeta_f(z) = \frac{1 + z}{1 - 2z^2}. \quad (18)$$

Equivalently, the parent fixed-point counts are 1 for odd n and $2^{k+1} - 1$ for $n = 2k$. These all-period statements follow from Lemma 3; the period-20 parent audit below is only an independent implementation check. The correction mechanism and the parent formula are used as prior-art reproduction baselines, not as novelty claims. Figure 2 displays the exact primitive ledger, the single boundary replacement, and the resulting rank-one instability-length lattice.

5.2 Factor orientation and determinant conventions

The *factor-orientation matrix* W in (7) satisfies

$$W^2 = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad W^3 = 0. \quad (19)$$

Consequently every positive-period signed trace vanishes and

$$\det(I - zW) = 1, \quad \zeta_W(z) = 1. \quad (20)$$

This factor-orientation-weighted SFT product is separate from the unsigned orbit zeta. After the frozen parent boundary convention, two still different objects are

$$D_{\text{or,parent}}(z) = 1 - z, \quad \zeta_{\text{Lef}}(z) = \frac{1}{1 - z}. \quad (21)$$

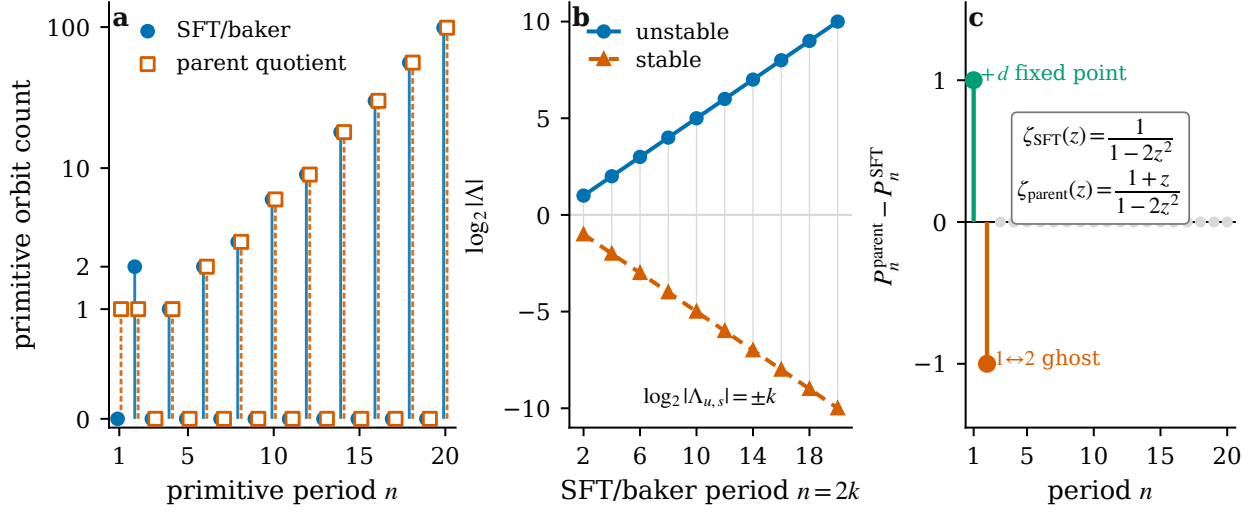


Figure 2: Two independent exact enumerations give 226 primitive symbolic cycles through period 20. The interval-factor quotient changes only one primitive boundary pair: it adds the fixed point d at period one and removes the symbolic orbit $1 \leftrightarrow 2$ at period two. All higher primitive-count differences vanish. Candidate instability lengths occupy the rank-one lattice $\{k \log 2 : k \geq 1\}$, whose rational-prime intersection is only $\log 2$.

The first is a parent factor-orientation object; it is not a Lefschetz zeta. Neither object supplies a two-dimensional symplectic orientation or a Maslov/quantum phase. An all-positive-sign null leaves A , the carrier areas, unsigned cycles, and symplectic branch determinants unchanged while destroying the nilpotent cancellation.

Corollary 4 (Rank-one clock for the frozen candidate). *For every primitive period- $2k$ orbit of the constant-slope Markov-baker,*

$$|\Lambda_u(C)| = 2^k, \quad L(C) = k \log 2. \quad (22)$$

The only rational prime p for which $L(C) = \log p$ is $p = 2$. The unsigned constant-slope multiplier product is

$$Z_u(s) := \prod_{C \text{ primitive}} \left(1 - e^{-sL(C)}\right)^{-1} = \det(I - 2^{-s/2}A)^{-1} = \frac{1}{1 - 2^{1-s}} = \frac{2^s}{2^s - 2}, \quad \text{Re } s > 1, \quad (23)$$

followed by the elementary meromorphic continuation of the displayed rational expression in 2^s .

Proof. The graph is bipartite, with parts $\{0, 1\}$ and $\{2\}$, so every closed walk has even period $2k$. Each edge has unstable multiplier modulus $\sqrt{2}$, hence a $2k$ -edge product has modulus 2^k and logarithm $k \log 2$. If this equals $\log p$, exponentiation gives $p = 2^k$, which is prime exactly when $k = 1$; period-two primitive orbits exist by (16). Finally the standard weighted-graph Euler product uses edge weight $2^{-s/2}$, so $Z_u(s) = \det(I - 2^{-s/2}A)^{-1}$. Substitution into $\det(I - zA) = 1 - 2z^2$ proves (23). Absolute convergence holds when the spectral radius $\sqrt{2}|2^{-s/2}|$ is below one, namely $\text{Re } s > 1$. $\square$

Corollary 4 concerns the source-locked Parry-affine branch cocycle. It does not compute the point-dependent derivative cocycle of the nonlinear parent (4). The latter lies outside Theorem 1;

finite PCF symbolic structure does not make its derivative locally constant. This distinction is consistent with the infinite-dimensional rational-map characteristic-exponent theorem of [Ji et al. \[2026\]](#).

6 Certified verification and matched controls

The proofs above settle the mathematical claims; computation checks that the implemented object is the declared one. The candidate, conventions, scales, controls, stopping rule, and forbidden-data policy were source-locked before validation. A version-2 amendment repaired only a mechanically mistranscribed development seed before any split was opened. No external prime or Riemann-zero table, target fitting, or target unfolding was used. All six exact preflight gates and all 89 unit/integration tests passed. The complete protocol, amendment, hashes, and access chain are recorded in [Appendix D](#) and the accompanying machine-readable passport.

An independent parent audit did not import the exact ledger generator. At 100 decimal digits it recovered parent periodic points through monotone inverse branches and reproduced the period-20 ledger and sole boundary duplicate; its maximum periodic residual was $9.706 \times 10^{-98} < 10^{-75}$. This supports implementation consistency, not interval certification and not the all-period proof, which is [Lemma 3](#).

Development, validation, and test each performed $65,536 \times 256 = 16,777,216$ identified per-step forward/inverse checks. Every split had zero edge mismatch and zero boundary failure, and the common maximum roundtrip error was 1.388×10^{-16} , below the frozen 2×10^{-13} threshold. These are deterministic software checks, not independent statistical observations. Six one-feature controls separately tested enumeration, paired reversal, dissipation, label loss, anti-symplectic rejection, and factor-sign cancellation. Their exact outcomes and inference limits are tabulated in [Appendix D](#); [Figure 3](#) is the compact visual summary.

7 Discussion and conclusion

The case study separates two questions that are easy to conflate. The three-rectangle carrier is compact, almost everywhere invertible, and exact symplectic on branch interiors; its intrinsic symbolic and parent ledgers are fully auditable. Yet its frozen multiplier clock has rank one. It therefore cannot provide an exact termwise all-prime ledger, regardless of further sampling or determinant manipulation.

The mathematical conclusion is that the carrier succeeds as a geometric and symbolic construction but fails as an exact all-prime multiplier clock; its primitive ledger is structural evidence only. For traceability, the source-locked project records this conclusion under the internal tags

PRE_A0_STRUCTURAL_PASS, AO_FAIL / STRUCTURAL_ONLY, A1_WEAK.

Here **A1_WEAK** means that the intrinsic orbit ledger is exact but contains no **A0** arithmetic labels; it is not an **A1_PASS**. Stages **A2–A4** are **STOP_SCOPED**, **Route B** is **FORBIDDEN**, and the overall candidate decision is **ROUTE_A_REJECTED**. The model remains useful as a structural positive control and an arithmetic negative control. Classical baker quantizations [[Balazs and Voros, 1989](#), [Saraceno, 1990](#)] do not change this gate: generic quantizability supplies neither missing arithmetic origin nor a canonical quantization of this clock.

The obstruction is exact but narrow. It does not cover point-dependent or Hölder roofs, countable-state or infinite-memory systems, growing sequences of finite models, nonmultiplicative matrix spectral radii or singular values, approximate/density matching, or signed analytic cancellation

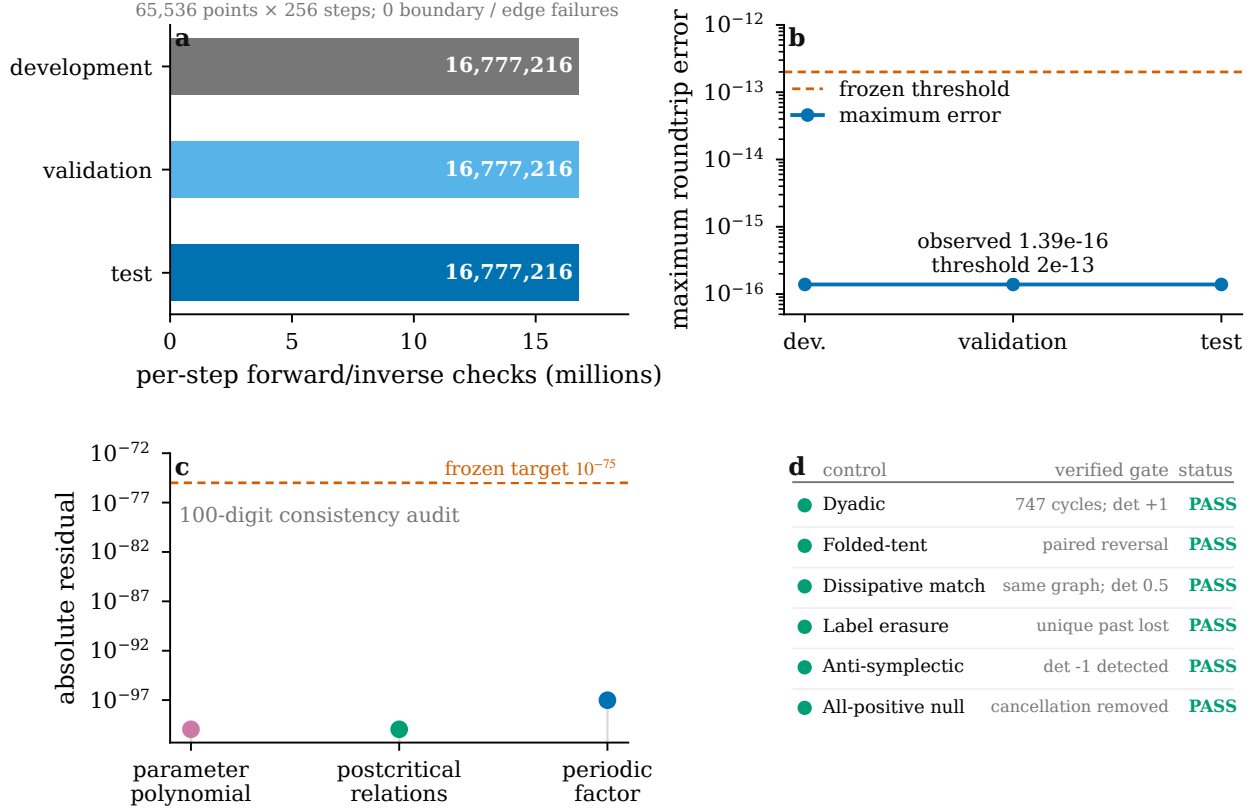


Figure 3: Frozen implementation and control audit. (a) Each of three splits completed 16,777,216 identified per-step forward/inverse checks with no boundary failure or edge mismatch. (b) Their common maximum roundtrip error was 1.388×10^{-16} , below the predeclared threshold. (c) Independent 100-digit parent residuals were below the 10^{-75} target; this was not interval certification. (d) Six matched controls separately test enumeration/symplecticity, paired reversal, dissipation, label loss, anti-symplectic rejection, and dependence of signed cancellation on factor signs.

under additional convergence hypotheses. It also does not apply to the nonlinear parent derivative; indeed, the infinite-rank theorem for characteristic exponents of non-exceptional rational maps [Ji et al., 2026] shows why finite coding and finite derivative rank must not be identified. Any independently motivated variable-roof, smoothed, countable-state, coupled, or higher-dimensional construction is a new candidate requiring a new source lock and an arithmetic-origin audit, not a post-hoc modification of this one.

The parent determinant and boundary-period discrepancy, generalized-baker platform, natural-extension strategy, higher-block recoding, locally constant weight framework, and generic baker quantization all have direct prior context. Accordingly, this paper is a specialist note: its contribution is the explicit rational-prime design certificate, the all-period boundary proof, and a convention-safe audited worked example. A valid carrier answers a geometric question; only an intrinsic clock can answer the arithmetic one.

Data, code, and assistance disclosure

All exact and numerical artifacts, source locks, audit scripts, figure generators, and frozen reports accompany this manuscript. No external prime or Riemann-zero data were used. Computation used only CPU resources. AI tools assisted code and manuscript review; all definitions, proofs, calculations, citations, and final claims were checked against the locked artifacts by the author. Any venue-specific disclosure wording should supersede this generic statement.

A Exact parent algebra

The isolating interval in (4) is an exact certificate. Its endpoint evaluations are

$$p(3859/2500) = -\frac{4136221}{15625000000} < 0, \quad p(15437/10000) = \frac{32678453}{10^{12}} > 0. \quad (24)$$

Moreover $p'(u) = 3u^2 - 4u + 2$ has negative discriminant and positive leading coefficient, hence is positive on $\mathbb{R}$. Thus p is strictly increasing and the interval contains its unique real root.

All PCF identities follow in $\mathbb{Q}[u]/(p)$. Clearly $f_u(0) = 1$ and $f_u(1) = 1 - u = -d$. Since

$$f_u(d) - d = 1 - u(u - 1)^2 - (u - 1) = -p(u), \quad (25)$$

we have $f_u(d) = d$; evenness also gives $f_u(-d) = d$. This proves (5) and the endpoint pairs (6). On the interval interiors, $f'_u(x) = -2ux$ is positive on I_0 and negative on I_1, I_2 . Combining these orientations with the endpoint images yields precisely the four entries of A and W in (7). This establishes the exact parent algebra independently of decimal root approximation.

B Branch formulas and boundary relation

Table 2 expands the offsets (10). All coordinates are local to the labeled source or destination rectangle. Write $b_* = 1/(2\sqrt{2})$.

Table 2: Closed strip allocation. Half-open ownership is specified below.

Edge	σ	s_{ij}	Source x -range	t_{ij}	Destination y -range
$0 \rightarrow 2$	+	0	$[0, 1/2]$	0	$[0, b_*]$
$1 \rightarrow 2$	−	0	$[0, 1/2]$	b_*	$[b_*, 1/\sqrt{2}]$
$2 \rightarrow 0$	−	0	$[0, b_*]$	0	$[0, 1/2]$
$2 \rightarrow 1$	−	b_*	$[b_*, 1/\sqrt{2}]$	0	$[0, 1/2]$

For an image point $(X, Y) \in R_j$ on the strip assigned to $i \rightarrow j$, the complete inverse of (11) is

$$B_{ij}^{-1}(X, Y) = \begin{cases} (s_{ij} + X/\lambda, \lambda(Y - t_{ij})), & \sigma_{ij} = +1, \\ (s_{ij} + (r_j - X)/\lambda, \ell_i - \lambda(Y - t_{ij})), & \sigma_{ij} = -1. \end{cases} \quad (26)$$

The deterministic forward implementation assigns the internal vertical face $x = b_*$ in R_2 to edge $2 \rightarrow 1$; the inverse implementation assigns the internal horizontal face $y = b_*$ in R_2 to edge $1 \rightarrow 2$. Equivalently, earlier strips are closed on the lower side and open on the upper side, while the last strip includes the outer upper endpoint. This choice affects only faces of zero area. The

closed-boundary relation instead uses every closed range in Table 2; formulas (11) and (26) are then mutually inverse on each edge, including its faces.

For completeness, the exactness generator in (13) can be read off edge by edge. If the first coordinate is $X = ax + b$, then $B^*\alpha - \alpha = dG_{ij}$, with

$$(G_{02}, G_{12}, G_{20}, G_{21}) = \left(0, -\frac{y}{2}, -\frac{y}{2\sqrt{2}}, -\frac{y}{\sqrt{2}}\right). \quad (27)$$

These are branch-local primitives; no global smooth gluing across strip faces is claimed.

C Cycle and determinant ledger

The characteristic polynomial of A is $t(t^2 - 2)$, which immediately gives (15) and $\det(I - zA) = 1 - 2z^2$. For a direct check independent of traces, enumerate all closed state words of length n , retain a word only if no proper divisor of n is a rotational period, and represent its orbit by the lexicographically least cyclic rotation. The trace/Möbius and direct procedures give the following complete count ledger.

Table 3: Primitive orbit counts through the frozen maximum period.

n	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
SFT P_n	0	2	0	1	0	2	0	3	0	6
Parent P_n	1	1	0	1	0	2	0	3	0	6
n	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
SFT P_n	0	9	0	18	0	30	0	56	0	99
Parent P_n	0	9	0	18	0	30	0	56	0	99

The parent ledger is obtained only after the declared quotient and should not be substituted for the unquotiented baker ledger in Corollary 4.

The signed convention is also transparent at the Euler-factor level. The removed symbolic two-cycle has factor-orientation product $(-1)(-1) = +1$, whereas the added parent fixed point d lies on a decreasing branch and has factor sign -1 . Starting from the unquotiented weighted product one, the replacement contributes

$$(1 - z^2)(1 + z)^{-1} = 1 - z, \quad (28)$$

which is the frozen object $D_{\text{or,parent}}$ in (21). This derivation also shows why it must not be called the Lefschetz zeta. Likewise, substituting edge weight $2^{-s/2}$ into A , but not into W , produces the unsigned multiplier-clock product (23); substitution into the nilpotent W instead gives the factor-orientation multiplier product one.

D Reproducibility passport

Evidence and matched controls

Table 4 records the inference boundary. Here “exact” means exact algebra or integer enumeration, not merely a passing tolerance.

Table 4: Evidence and inference boundary.

Audit	Observed result	Supports / does not support
PCF, PF, branch algebra	All symbolic residuals zero	Declared carrier / no global smoothness
Two primitive ledgers	Vector (16), total 226	Exact SFT counts / no arithmetic labels
Boundary quotient	Lemma 3; audit through period 20	All-period parent quotient / not novel boundary theory
Factor orientation	$W^3 = 0$, $\det(I - zW) = 1$	Convention check / no quantum phase
Parent audit	100 digits; max residual 9.706×10^{-98}	Independent consistency / no interval proof
Three floating splits	$3 \times 16,777,216$ checks; max error 1.388×10^{-16}	Stable implementation / no sampling inference
Six controls	Every intended gate passed	Failure-mode specificity / no A2–A4 evidence
Static isolation	Zero forbidden-data violation	Data discipline / no external target comparison

The six controls alter one structural feature at a time. A dyadic baker is the positive enumeration/symplecticity control and has 747 primitive binary necklaces through period 12. A folded-tent baker verifies paired stable and unstable reversal with determinant (+1). A matched dissipative map keeps the future graph but has determinant (1/2) and a non-surjective image. Erasing labels breaks unique past reconstruction; reversing only one coordinate gives determinant (-1) and is rejected. Finally, replacing all factor signs by (+1) preserves the unsigned carrier but removes the nilpotent cancellation. These controls separate enumeration, coding, invertibility, symplecticity, and sign convention.

Artifact and execution record

All computations refer to candidate `pcf_markov_baker_v1`, source lock version 2, with source-lock SHA-256

20473ff34b1f9258281483f47b9db915eb2680d2a71e9e1e6e9f3cf3d6fc07c8

and frozen code-tree SHA-256

ad7f6637a90e6f5cfc4933b89adc70c543c0d0f259f295ea84da10c6fa5f0b11.

The pre-test verification manifest has SHA-256

e3e79e94e1e7ec684cd66748498c7aba238eb25bbef629c778a069b755640c54.

and records that the test had not been accessed before it was created. The final manifest contains hashes for every result artifact. Figure generators and their exact JSON inputs are separately recorded with the figure package; PDF creation timestamps preclude a claim of byte-identical rerendering.

The split seed rule takes the unsigned big-endian integer represented by the first eight bytes of `SHA256(pcf_markov_baker_v1:split)`. It gives

$$\begin{aligned}
s_{\text{dev}} &= 9296786003925294372, \\
s_{\text{val}} &= 6299270948367439428, \\
s_{\text{test}} &= 17469014571681933606.
\end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

Version 1 transcribed the development value as 18394334463172922998. The version-2 amendment repaired this mismatch before any run. A post-test development rerun to a temporary path was byte-identical to the frozen file; the sealed test was not rerun.

The recorded environment was Python 3.12.3 on Linux 5.4.0-155-generic x86_64 (glibc 2.35), with NumPy 2.4.4, SymPy 1.14.0, mpmath 1.3.0, SciPy 1.16.1, and pytest 9.0.3. No GPU was used. The principal machine-readable outputs are `results/exact_preflight.json`, `results/ledger.json`, `results/parent_audit.json`, the three `results/float_stress_*.json` files, and `results/final_result_manifest.json`. The source lock and access chain are under `experiments/`.

For a clean copy with fresh output paths, the documented entry-point order is

```
python -m pytest
python code/scripts/run_exact_preflight.py
python code/scripts/run_ledger.py
python code/scripts/audit_ledger.py
python code/scripts/run_float_stress.py --split development
python code/scripts/analyze_carrier.py --split development
python code/scripts/freeze_splits.py validation
python code/scripts/run_float_stress.py --split validation
python code/scripts/analyze_carrier.py --split validation
python code/scripts/freeze_splits.py test
python code/scripts/run_float_stress.py --split test
python code/scripts/analyze_carrier.py --split test
```

This is a reconstruction from the non-overwriting command-line entry points and frozen artifact order, not a claim that a literal historical shell transcript was retained. The entry points refuse to overwrite frozen JSON. Validation and test execution must follow their hash/unlock gates.

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